

BUSINESS AGENT HARNESS

Internal Implementation Framework

Implementation objective

Build a repeatable business agent harness that can be installed for different clients without rebuilding governance from scratch.

The framework must support:

- client-facing explanation,
- internal technical setup,
- Discord server/channel/role configuration,
- agent roster and permission model,
- approval gates,
- monitoring and receipts,
- training and handover.

Reference architecture

Business users ↓ requests / approvals Discord server operating room ↓ channel permissions + bot roles Agent gateway / harness layer ↓ policies, memory, receipts, escalation rules Specialist agents ↓ read/draft/report/check actions Business tools and documents

Harness components

Component	Required	Notes
Discord server	Yes	Shared room for requests, approvals, and receipts
Discord bot/app	Yes	One bot identity per environment or per agent lane, depending on setup
Agent gateway	Yes	Routes messages from Discord to agent profiles and back
Agent profiles	Yes	Separate instructions, tool access, and memory boundaries
Memory / handoff store	Yes	Stores summaries, decisions, project state, receipts
Approval policy	Yes	Defines what requires human sign-off

Monitoring/reporting	Yes	Daily digest, errors, blocked actions, uptime/status
Business tool connectors	Optional	Only after safe-room phase is stable

Internal role map

Role	Person	Responsibility
Project owner	Michael / client sponsor	Commercial scope, final go/no-go
Harness implementer	Technical lead	Server, agents, gateway, docs, tests
Business champion	Client-side operator	Staff training, use-case triage
Access owner	Client IT/admin	Approves tool access and permissions
Agent maintainer	Michael/team	Monitors failures, improves prompts/tools
Department lead	Client manager	Approves department-specific actions

Agent profile template

Every business agent should have an agent card:

```
agent_name: Reporting Agent
business_owner: Operations Manager
purpose: Summarise daily operational activity and draft weekly reports
allowed_channels: - daily-briefings - agent-reports
allowed_tools: - read approved reporting folder - summarise uploaded CSV/PDF/DOCX - draft reports
approval_required_for: - publishing reports externally - emailing reports to customers - changing dashboard formulas
forbidden: - payroll access - deleting files - changing user permissions
receipt_required: true
fallback: tag @Agent Maintainer in #incident-log
```

Channel taxonomy

Channel type	Naming pattern	Purpose
Helpdesk	#agent-helpdesk	General requests and triage
Approval	#approvals	Human sign-off before sensitive actions
Department	#sales-agent , #ops-agent	Department-specific workflows
Reporting	#daily-briefings , #agent-reports	Summaries, handovers, metrics
Support	#incident-log , #agent-admin	Errors, access issues, maintenance
Read-only library	#agent-how-to , #templates	Staff guidance and prompt examples

Permission classes

Class	Meaning	Example
View	Can read channel/file/tool data	Research agent sees public supplier docs
Draft	Can propose text or changes	Admin agent drafts email but cannot send
Comment	Can add notes or labels	Reporting agent comments on task status
Write	Can edit approved records	Only after workflow is tested
Send/publish	Can communicate externally	Usually human approval required
Admin	Can change users, roles, config	Humans only by default

Approval gates

Use a standard approval phrase in Discord:

```
APPROVED: [agent/action] for [scope] until [time/window]. Approved by [name].
```

Example:

```
APPROVED: Reporting Agent may generate the weekly operations report from the June dashboard and post a draft in #agent-reports today only. Approved by Sarah.
```

Agents should refuse or escalate if approval is missing, ambiguous, stale, or out of scope.

Standard business workflows

1. Research and summary

- User asks in `#agent-helpdesk`.
- Coordinator routes to Research Agent.
- Research Agent replies with sources and confidence.
- If external contact is needed, agent drafts only and asks for approval.

2. Customer response drafting

- Staff paste customer context into approved channel.
- Support Drafting Agent writes a suggested response.
- Staff edits/sends manually unless explicit send authority exists.
- Agent records theme in daily summary.

3. Daily operations briefing

- Reporting Agent reviews approved logs or uploads.
- Posts a concise daily briefing.

- Flags blockers, overdue approvals, and repeated issues.
- Does not change source systems unless separately approved.

4. Document/SOP drafting

- User requests SOP from known facts.
- Admin Agent drafts in channel or approved docs area.
- Department lead reviews and marks approved.
- Final copy is stored in the business library.

Internal acceptance tests

Before handover, verify:

- staff user can ask in `#agent-helpdesk`,
- non-manager cannot approve sensitive action,
- manager can approve in `#approvals`,
- agent refuses a forbidden request,
- agent posts a receipt after completing a safe request,
- daily briefing can be generated,
- incident can be logged,
- agent cannot see private channels it should not access,
- all bot tokens/secrets are stored outside client-visible docs,
- disaster fallback / disable process is documented.

Monitoring and operations

Daily:

- check `#incident-log`,
- check failed tasks,
- review daily briefing quality,
- identify repeated request types.

Weekly:

- tune agent prompts,
- remove unused channels,
- update templates,
- review access register,
- check approval logs,
- confirm staff questions are decreasing.

Monthly:

- review ROI metrics,

- rotate/review credentials where applicable,
- test disable/revoke path,
- assess whether any agent should gain or lose permissions.

Internal risk register

Risk	Control
Agent gets too much access	Small keyrings, channel-specific bot roles, read/draft-first policy
Staff over-trust outputs	Training, confidence labels, source links, review gates
Private data leaks into broad channels	Channel map, department permissions, redaction rules
Approval ambiguity	Standard approval phrase and expiry window
Silent failure	Incident channel, daily status, watchdog/reporting
Client asks for unsafe automation	Refuse, propose draft-only or approval-gated alternative

Handover standard

Do not consider the install complete until:

- the client sponsor has seen the approval workflow,
- at least one staff member has completed a practice request,
- an agent has refused an unsafe request correctly,
- the business champion knows where to report issues,
- the access register is complete,
- the training guide is delivered.